

HEI SCHOOLS®

BRAND VISUAL

STANDARDS

Last updated: Dec 3, 2025

Introduction

This manual has been developed to ensure a consistent, warm, and trusted brand experience across all locations and communication. These visual guidelines provide a unified framework for how the HEI Schools brand is presented across all centers worldwide. By aligning colors, typography, imagery, and overall design principles, the guidelines help every location communicate with the same clarity, warmth, and professionalism. Consistent presentation strengthens recognition and builds trust among families, ensuring that the HEI Schools experience feels reliable and familiar no matter where it is encountered.

About HEI Schools®



HEI Schools (Helsinki International Schools) was co-founded by the University of Helsinki and experienced educational and design experts in 2016. Embracing Nordic values of accessibility and openness, we want to make high-quality early childhood education globally available. We wanted to make this possible through a scalable, easy-to-implement licensing model, offering the curriculum, teacher training, learning environment design, carefully selected learning materials and operational support needed to start a premium preschool. The model is based on the proven Finnish education approach and Nordic heritage of high-quality everyday design.

We take a research-based approach with creative, high-level teacher training and continuous pedagogical improvements. Having the University of Helsinki as a co-founder and shareholder differentiates us from other education companies because we are able to constantly develop our research-based pedagogical model.

Mission and Vision

At HEI Schools we are on a mission to provide high-quality education to as many children and families in the world as possible. Following a child-centric, play-based learning approach based on Finland's educational model, we want to show that learning is fun.

Core Values

We respect the Nordic heritage of democracy, openness and accessibility. We are open, tolerant and respectful. Our efforts of what we do will promote environmental, social and economic sustainability. We believe in respecting individual capabilities and personal features as well as differences between people.

Brand Personality

Our brand personality reflects the values at the heart of HEI Schools. We aim to be warm and nurturing, creating a sense of comfort and care for children and families. At the same time, we uphold a professional standard in everything we do, ensuring that our communication and operations reflect expertise and reliability. As a global early education brand, we are also globally aware—embracing diverse cultures, perspectives, and communities. Together, these qualities shape a brand that feels welcoming, trusted, and connected across all HEI Schools locations.





Trademark & Logo

HEI Schools® Trademark

HEI Schools® is the official brand and a registered trademark. It is important to maintain the integrity of the brand name by ensuring that it is not shortened, altered, or divided in any way.

All components of the name must be used together and should never be separated or divided in any context.

HEI SCHOOLS

HEI Schools

In the HEI Schools brand, “HEI” is always presented in all capital letters, while “Schools” can be shown either in all caps or in title case.

Incorrect usage and common mistakes

~~HEI School[®]~~

~~HEI Preschool~~

~~Hei Schools~~

~~HEI International Schools~~

~~Hei schools~~

~~HEI kindergarten~~

If local regulations prohibit the use of the term “school” in the local name or related materials, the operator must consult with and seek a solution together with HEI HQ approval.

Primary Logo

Our logo is the key building block of our identity, the primary visual element that defines us. The signature is a combination of the glyph and the wordmark which is our company name – they have a fixed relationship that should **never be changed in any way**.



Logo construction and safety area

It is important to keep corporate marks clear of any other graphic elements. To regulate this, an exclusion zone has been established around the corporate mark. This exclusion zone indicates the closest any other graphic element or message can be positioned in relation to the mark of the symbol itself and our company name – they have a fixed relationship that should never be changed in any way.



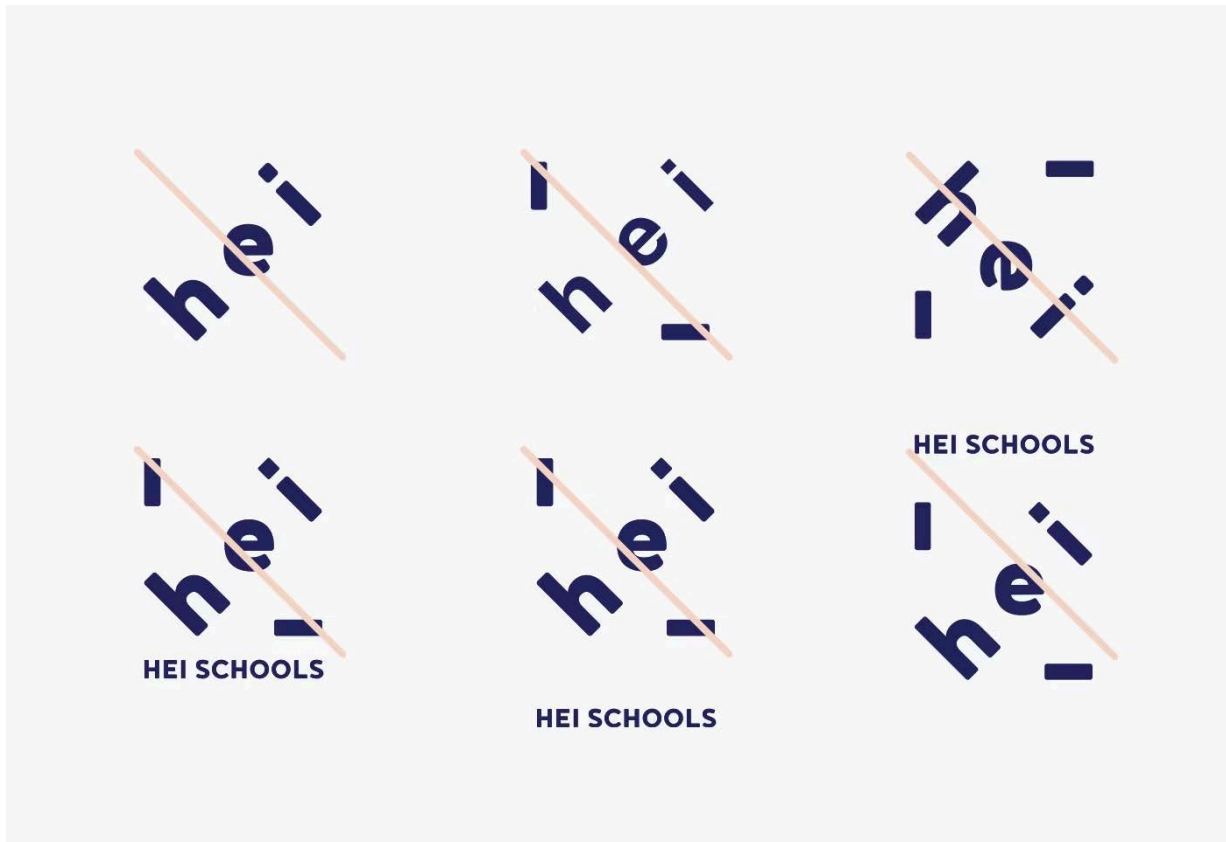


Logo application and standards

Forest Green and Ocean Blue are our signature logo colors. Always pair them with backgrounds that provide high color contrast to ensure optimal visibility.



Incorrect use of our logo



- **Do not** alter the logo symbol (for example take elements away)
- **Do not** alter the logo typography
- **Do not** rotate the logo
- **Do not** replace the wordmark too close to the glyph, too far from it or change the position
- **Do not** change the size proportions between the glyph or wordmark
- **Do not** change the proportions of the logo vertically or horizontally or alter the appearance in any way
- **Do not** drop shadow

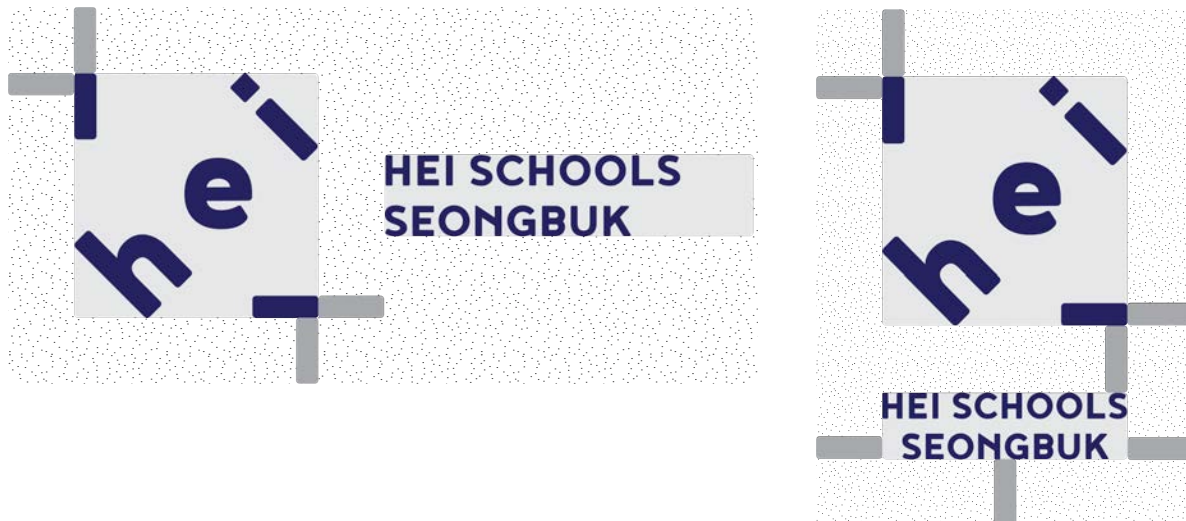


Location-specific Logos

Each school will have their own local logo and the logo file will be provided by HEI HQ. All schools are named according to the area in which they are located. **The local name must be reviewed and approved by HEI Headquarters.** You must strictly follow the naming guidelines and must not create or use any school name without prior approval from HEI Headquarters.

Logo variation and safety area

For location-specific logos, HEI HQ will supply the official files with the approved location name added. Each center will receive two versions of the logo – one horizontal and one vertical.



Local language version

In some cases country legislation demands that logos should be written in dual language for example in signages. Then the language version is added below the name. Please pay attention that the language version typography follows the HEI Schools typography (rounded corners).



Typography

Typography guidelines

1. **All external, customer-facing headlines**

Noyh Heavy is primarily used for the logo and headlines across all HEI Schools communications.

NOYH HEAVY

2. **All external, customer-facing text and content**, particularly on printed body text.

Caecilia LT

3. **When Noyh Heavy or Caecilia LT cannot be used**, Proxima Nova serves as the alternative font, particularly on digital body text.

Proxima Nova

>> Download fonts [here](#) <<

International font substitutes

- For Chinese characters, we use Noto Sans CJK.
- For Korean characters, we use NanumSquareRound.
- For Thai characters, we use Opun.

Pairing

THE HEADLINE

The subheadline

Body text and content

- Use Noyh Heavy for the headline and emphasis
- Use Caecilia LT for subheadline and body text

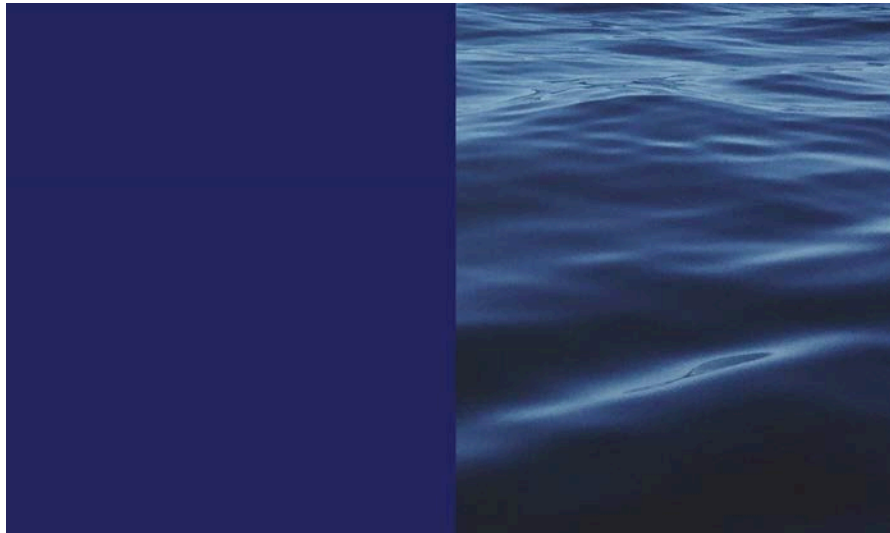
Examples:



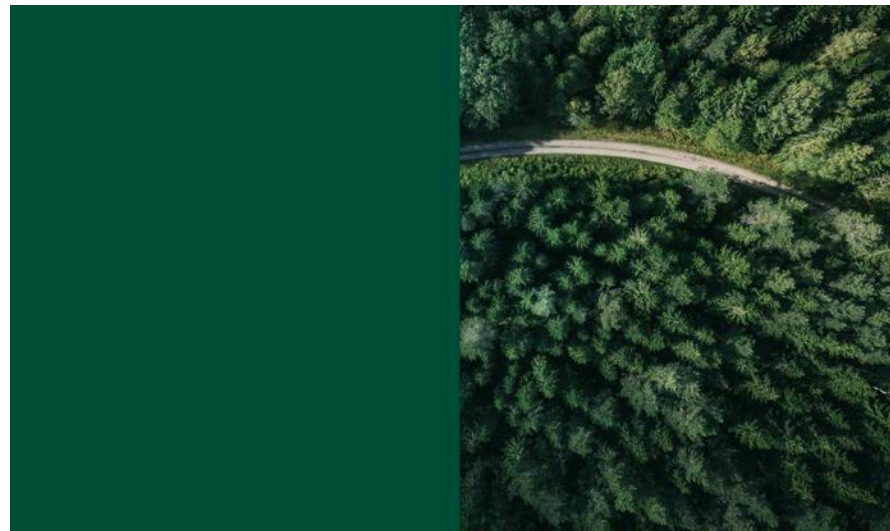
Colors

Colors play an important role in the HEI Schools identity. We use a palette of greens and dark blue to reinforce brand recognition. Ensure that brand greens are always present.

Primary colors



OCEAN BLUE
PANTONE 2747
C100 M100 Y30 K20
R50 G40 B100
292663



FOREST GREEN
PANTONE 336
C90 M40 Y80 K40
R1 G80 B60
01503B

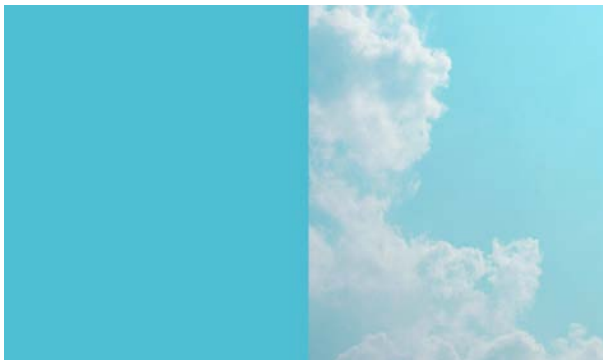
Support colors



DARK GREY
PANTONE Black U
C0 M0 Y0 K98
R40 G40 B40
1A1818



MINT GREEN
PANTONE 337
C55 M2 Y50 K0
R130 G228 B182
65B784



SKY BLUE
PANTONE 3105
C54 M0 Y13 K0
R80 G200 B210
52C7D0



GRAIN YELLOW
PANTONE 1225
C4 M25 Y81 K0
R245 G194 B64
F5C240



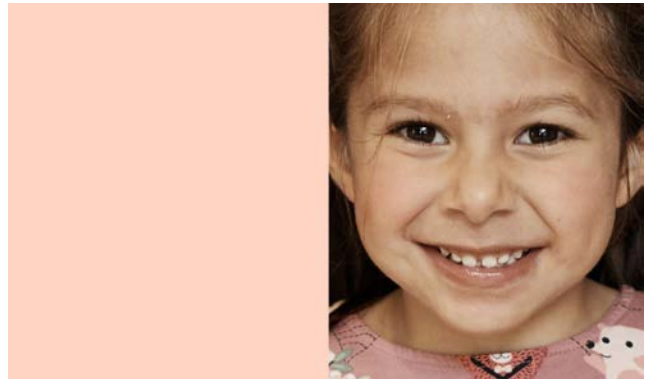
THIS IS FUN

PANTONE WARM GREY 1

C7 M11 Y17 K0

R240 G230 B214

EDE4D5



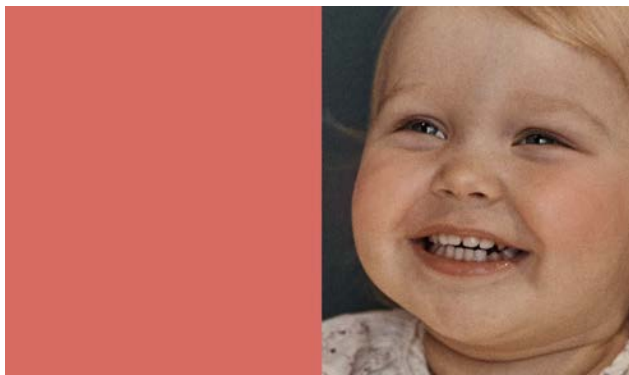
CAN'T STOP SMILING

PANTONE 162

C0 M20 Y19 K0

R254 G211 B194

FDD3C1



BEST TIMES EVER

PANTONE 7417

C6 M76 Y70 K0

R212 G106 B88

D46A58

Color balance guidance



Incorrect use of graphic elements



- **Do not** use non-HEI Schools-style graphics
- **Do not** put noisy background
- **Do not** use gradient color as a background
- **Do not** use non-HEI Schools color as main colors

Photography

Capture authentic, joyful moments of children learning, exploring, and interacting with a thoughtfully designed environment. The imagery should feel warm, natural, modern, and child-centered, highlighting play, collaboration, and real-world learning experiences.

Mood & Tone

- Uplifting, positive, and energetic
- Calm and secure atmosphere - no tension or overstimulation
- Genuine emotion: curiosity, joy, concentration, connection

Visual Style

- Minimalist and modern: Clean, uncluttered backgrounds, with natural features and neutral palettes.
- Natural lighting wherever possible
- Soft shadows and balanced exposure
- Slightly warm color temperature
- Lifestyle/documentary photography: Soft lighting, high-quality composition, and angles that match a child's perspective.

Environment & Styling

- Highlight natural materials

Image Treatments

- **Do not** use any color filters on the photos (e.g., sepia)

Social Media

Social media plays a key role in connecting with prospective families: nearly 40% of customers trust only the brands they have already engaged with online.

Your social media channels act as your “shop windows,” offering a clear view of why families should choose a HEI Schools Center. They allow you to inform and inspire your local community, build familiarity, and help parents feel confident considering your center for their child’s education.

With people spending an average of 3 hours a day on social platforms, each moment is an opportunity – similar to a curious parent arriving at your doorstep. It’s a chance to start a conversation and share what makes your school special.

Social media setup

Local operators may create their own social media accounts. The choice of platforms should be based on local context and the channels most commonly used by your target audience. All account names **must include the location-specific center name** and **be approved by HEI HQ** before they are launched.

Social media photos

Ensure that all photographs are high-quality and reflect the HEI Schools visual identity. Maintain clean, uncluttered backgrounds and use focal length to gently blur any unnecessary details, keeping the subject clear and in focus. (see [Photography](#))

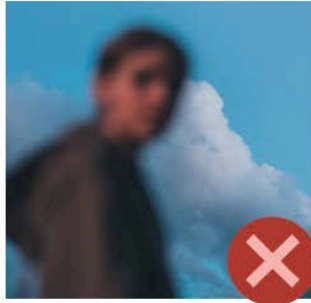


Adding text and graphics to the photos

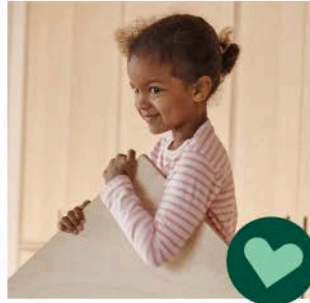
Use HEI Schools **fonts**, **color palette**, and **illustration style** consistently in social media photos. Keep layouts clean and uncluttered. Apply text and illustrations sparingly to maintain visual clarity and brand integrity.



Dos and don'ts



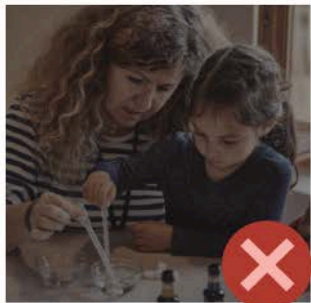
Blurry



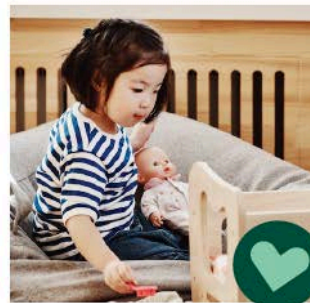
Sharp

Do: Take sharp photos

- Focus on keeping your hands steady while taking a photo
- Make sure you have enough light in the space. That way, you can take sharp photos of moving children
- When taking a photo with your phone, click your screen to make the camera focus on the object you are capturing
- Take several photos of one situation to make sure one of them is sharp
- Do not post blurry or low-quality photos



Too dark



Good amount of natural light

Do: Take bright photos

- Open the curtains to let natural light in
- Take photos from the same direction where the light comes in. This avoids creating shadows in the photo that make it appear dark



Too far away



Focus on the child

Do: Focus on children

- Try to get close to children when taking photos - close-up shots show their emotions, play and other actions
- Minimize or remove irrelevant people and things by taking photos from different angles
- Or create the same effect by cropping existing photos
- Mess is natural but let's keep that out of the photos
- N.B. The more you zoom and crop, the bigger the pixels. This can make your photo look grainy and unclear
- Make sure the photo quality is still high!



Too much stuff around the child



Calm environment and focus on the child



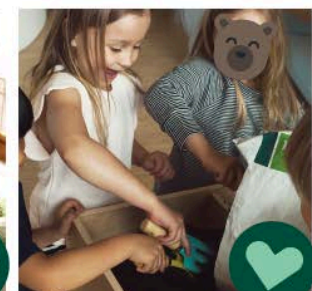
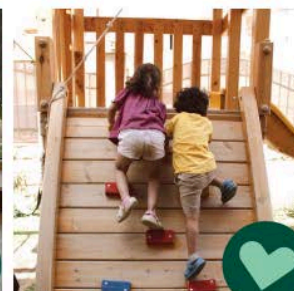
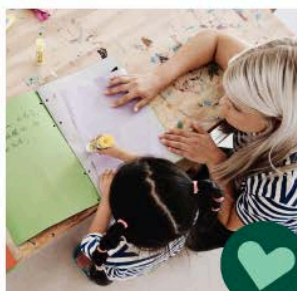
Do not smudge



Try different angles

Do: Be aware of photo rights

- Be careful about the rights of using children's photos on social media
- In many countries it is illegal to take photos of a child at daycare and publish them in social media without the parents' written permission
- If there are children whose parents haven't given permission, leave them out by cropping the images or using different angles to capture the moments. Take photos from behind or above the children
- If you use photos where children's faces are recognizable, cover them with HEI "stickers" like the heads of HEI characters or something neutral





Too many elements



Creates interest

Do: Keep photos clear and calm

- You can combine photos with some text or other small visual elements, but make sure your photo is the focus
- Make the text catchy so the viewer wants to read more in the caption
- Use the caption to explain the post and include all needed information
- The less text in the photo or illustration, the better



Wrong colors and font



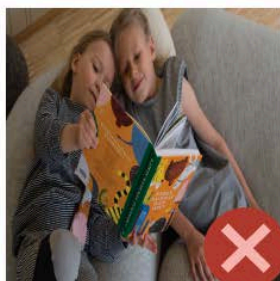
Right HEI colors and font

Do: Use HEI branded elements

- Small details create consistency and our characters like their original colors!
- Make sure you use the right HEI colors and fonts
- Download the HEI colors and fonts from our marketing kit. You can also see them on the next pages!



Don't create collages



Don't stretch or squeeze

Do not: Make collages

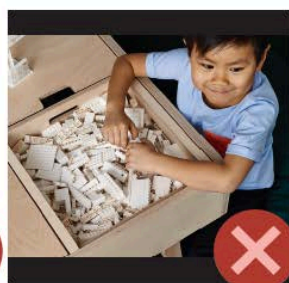
- Avoid making image collages because the more images you add, the harder it will be to actually see what is in the photos
- Instead, post the same photos as a carousel or save them later to post separately
- That way, your feed gets several lovely photos instead of just one!

Do not: Squeeze or stretch

- When moving or changing the size of our photos, we can accidentally stretch or squeeze them
- Before posting, make sure your photos look right



No filters or shadows



No borders

Do not: Use special effects, strong filters or borders

- Zoom/crop photos to fit the square (1:1) format if you are posting on Instagram

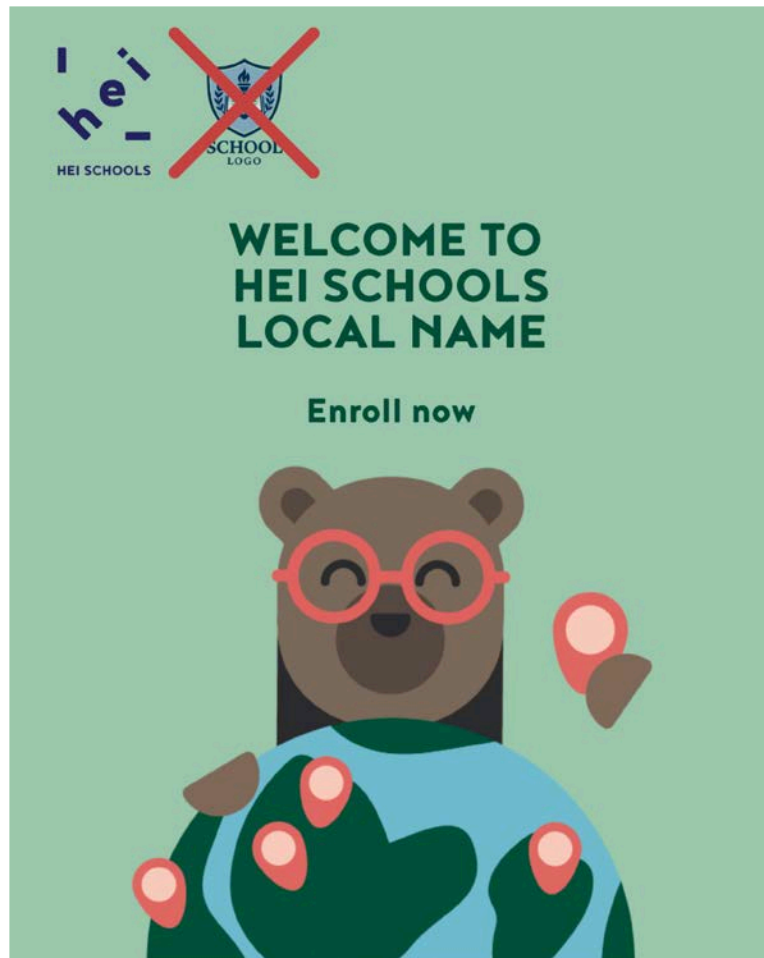
Co-Branding and Partnership

Co-branding is not permitted. HEI Schools may not be presented on websites, social media channels, or any other marketing materials under any name other than HEI Schools®

If you manage multiple brands, HEI Schools cannot be promoted as part of another brand. It must be marketed independently. Joint promotion is allowed only in a clearly collaborative context.

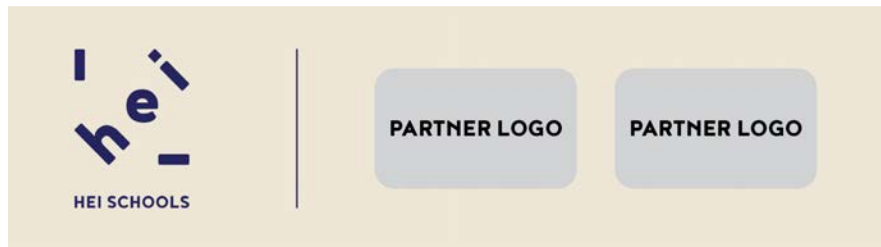
Logo placement

Do not include other brand logos in any HEI Schools marketing materials.



Events and partnership

When **an event involves other brand partners**, their logos may be displayed, but must be placed at a clear distance from the Heischools logo to avoid implying ownership, endorsement, or affiliation beyond the specific event.



Social media

If you need to coordinate activity between brands in your portfolio, you can use Instagram's collaboration feature to do so.



heischoolsbogotacbk and buckingham_school

